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MDMIE01 | WEEK 09 | MODULE 4

Who Actually Wants This?

Customer Segments, Customer Discovery and Updating the Business Model

From business-model assumptions to customer evidence

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COURSE ARC

You Are Still Building the Same Story

1. Weeks 1-4: Problem + customer
2. Week 5: Generate + choose
3. Week 6: Test
4. Week 7: Interpret + decide
5. Week 8: Build business logic
6. Week 9: Take the business logic back to reality

Your canvas is a set of hypotheses, not a certificate that your business works.

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STARTING POINT

Bring Back Your Week 08 Canvas

You should already have all of this filled in.

Customer Segment	Channels	Revenue hypothesis	Key Activities	Key Partners
Value Proposition	Customer Relationship	or UNKNOWN	Key Resources	Cost Structure

E = Evidence. A = Assumption. UNKNOWN is allowed. We are not starting again.

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THE SHIFT

Week 08 Asked “How Might This Work?”

WEEK 08

Who gets value?
Who pays?
How do we deliver?
What must happen?

WEEK 09

HOW DO WE KNOW ANY OF THAT IS TRUE?

Business-model design creates hypotheses. Customer discovery tests them.

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ISA PRESENTATION

Presentation 1 Still Stays Five Slides

1	2	3	4	5
Problem, Context and Target User	Customer Evidence	Journey, Pain Point and HMW	Selected Direction and Prototype	Assumption, Test, Result, Decision and What Changed

DO NOT ADD A CUSTOMER DISCOVERY SLIDE. Week 09 discovery may make Slides 1, 2 and 5 stronger. Presentation 1 remains exactly FIVE slides.

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TODAY

What We Are Doing Today

1. Sharpen the customer segment
2. Find the first useful customer group
3. Understand customer discovery
4. Learn what to ask
5. Practise an interview
6. Turn conversations into evidence
7. Update BMC + Value Proposition
8. Use real company examples
9. Prepare a real discovery sprint

Formal activities: three only. Includes time for break, transitions and discussion.

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PART 1

Stop Saying “Everyone”

Customer Segments and Discovery Conversations

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CUSTOMER SEGMENT

A Segment Is Not True Because It Is Written in a Box

WEAK

Second-year engineering students

BETTER

Second-year engineering students actively looking for internships and relying on scattered opportunity channels.

Your customer segment is still a hypothesis.

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SEGMENTATION

Age and Department Are Not Enough

A

WEAK

18-21 year-olds

B

BETTER

Students applying for their first technical internship

C

STRONGER CONTEXT

Students applying for their first technical internship who currently depend on scattered WhatsApp, LinkedIn and college-group updates.

Segment around something relevant to the problem and behaviour.

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SEGMENT SHARPENER

Four Ways to Make a Segment More Useful

1

WHO

Who are they?

2

CONTEXT

What situation are they in?

3

BEHAVIOUR

What are they currently doing?

4

NEED / PROBLEM

What are they struggling with?

Example: local café owners + no internal marketing employee + posting irregularly + struggling to connect marketing activity to enquiries.

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EVIDENCE DISCIPLINE

Segmentation Is Not Stereotyping

BAD

“Gen Z hates paying.”

BETTER

“The users we interviewed currently avoid paid tools and use free alternatives.”

Segment from evidence, not stereotypes.

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FIRST CUSTOMER

Start Where the Problem Is Clearest

A useful first customer group often:

- Feels the problem frequently
- Already tries to solve it
- Spends time, money or effort on a workaround
- Can explain the pain clearly
- Is reachable for learning

Important

This does NOT mean they will definitely buy. They are simply useful people to learn from first.

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BEHAVIOUR

Pain Leaves Footprints

Repeated workaround	**Repeated complaint**	**Manual spreadsheet**	**Multiple apps**	**Repeated phone calls**

Current behaviour is usually more useful than future promises.

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B2C vs B2B

Customer Discovery Does Not Look the Same Everywhere

B2C EXAMPLE: Student opportunity service

User: Student
Buyer: Maybe student
Payer: UNKNOWN

B2B EXAMPLE: Small-business cybersecurity service

User: Employee / IT person
Buyer: Owner / manager
Payer: Company

In B2B, you may need to talk to more than one role.

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WEEK 08 CONNECTION

User, Buyer and Payer Return

USER

“What happens when you face this?”

BUYER

“How do you decide whether to adopt a solution?”

PAYER

“What currently gets budget?”

One interview cannot always answer the whole business model.

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CURRENT CASE | JULY 2026

Swiggy Late Night Eats

A Segment Defined by Situation, Not Just Age

What happened

Launched 3 July 2026, designed specifically for professionals working late. Available across 4,000+ office locations, 30,000+ restaurants, top 30 cities. Swiggy said 25% of corporate employees in those locations place food orders after 10 PM while at the office.

Why it matters

Segment is NOT “young people” but professionals working late from offices. Context: 10 PM onwards + office + extended/global schedules. Possible value dimensions: speed, affordability, relevance, office-friendly ordering.

Source: Swiggy Corporate | 03 Jul 2026

Takeaway

A strong segment often describes WHEN, WHERE and WHY the problem happens, not just who the person is.

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CASE DISCUSSION

What Did Swiggy Segment On?

Was the segment mainly:

A	B	C	D
Age	Department	Behaviour + Context	Random demographics

A strong segment often describes WHEN, WHERE and WHY the problem happens. This is a discussion slide, not a formal activity.

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ACTIVITY 1

Segment Sharpener

Duration

15 minutes

Format

Permanent teams

1. Take your Week 08 Customer Segment.
2. Rewrite it using: WHO, CONTEXT, CURRENT BEHAVIOUR, PROBLEM / NEED.
3. Who would you interview first tomorrow?
4. Why them?
5. What evidence do you already have?
6. What are you still assuming?

Expected output

One sharper segment statement + first interview target.

Faculty challenge if you write “Students”: Which students, doing what, in what situation?

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WORKED EXAMPLE

From Broad to Useful

BEFORE

Students looking for internships

AFTER

Second-year engineering students applying for their first internships who currently rely on several scattered channels to check opportunities, eligibility and deadlines.

Still a hypothesis until further discovery supports it.

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CUSTOMER DISCOVERY

Discovery Is Learning, Not Selling

Customer discovery tests assumptions about:

Customer	**Problem**	**Current behaviour**
Workaround	**Decision process**	**Value**
Channel	**Payer**	**Other business-model hypotheses**

Purpose

The purpose is learning something that could change your business model.

Source: Steve Blank | Customer Development

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DISCOVERY MINDSET

Discovery Is Not Pitching

WEAK

“We have built this amazing app. Would you use it?”

BETTER

“Tell me about the last time you faced this problem.”

UNDERSTAND BEFORE YOU CONVINCE.

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INTERVIEW GOAL

Your Goal Is Not “Yes”

THE OBJECTIVE IS NOT

Getting compliments
Proving you are right
Getting “yes”
Convincing someone to download
Defending your idea

THE OBJECTIVE IS

LEARNING SOMETHING THAT COULD CHANGE A DECISION

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BETTER EVIDENCE

Past Behaviour Beats Future Promises

WEAK

- Would you use an app that solves this?
- Would you pay ₹299?

STRONGER

- What happened the last time you faced this?
- What do you currently spend money, time or effort on?

Future promises are easy. Past behaviour gives context.

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INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Five Useful Discovery Questions

1. What is the hardest part of doing this today?
2. Tell me about the last time this happened.
3. What made it difficult?
4. What did you do about it?
5. What did you dislike about the solution or workaround you tried?

Follow the conversation. Do not mechanically interrogate.

Source: Y Combinator Startup School | User Interviews

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FOLLOW-UP

Follow the Interesting Sentence

Customer says: “I usually ask my senior.”

Do NOT immediately move to the next prepared question.
Ask instead:
Why your senior?
What do you ask them?
When did that happen last?
What happens if they do not know?

KEY LINE

Discovery happens in the follow-up.

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AVOID THESE

Questions That Damage the Interview

- “Don't you think this is useful?”
- “Wouldn't AI make this better?”
- “Would you pay ₹500?”
- “Do you like our idea?”
- “What features should we build?”

Weak because: they lead the person, expose the preferred answer, encourage guessing, and turn discovery into product feedback.

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LISTEN FOR

Behaviour, Not Adjectives

- Frequency
- Specific incident
- Emotional frustration
- Time lost
- Money spent
- Workaround
- Person involved
- Decision authority
- Switching behaviour
- Trust issue
- Reason something failed

LISTEN FOR BEHAVIOUR, NOT ADJECTIVES.

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ACTIVITY 2

Discovery Interview Roleplay

Duration

25 minutes

Format

Pairs inside permanent teams

1. Student A: INTERVIEWER. Student B: CUSTOMER. Student C / observer: NOTES. Then switch roles.
2. Allowed prompts: hardest part, last time, why difficult, what did you do, what did you dislike.
3. Prohibited for first five minutes: pitching, demo, solution explanation, “would you use”, “would you pay”.

Expected output

One discovery note card.

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ACTIVITY OUTPUT

Discovery Note Card

PRACTICE / SIMULATION

CUSTOMER CONTEXT	LAST REAL INCIDENT	CURRENT WORKAROUND	PAIN
Who were they / what situation?	What happened?	What did they do?	What was difficult?

COST	DECISION	EVIDENCE	SURPRISE
Time / money / effort / risk	Who decided what happened next?	What supports our assumption?	What did we not expect?

Roleplay responses are for interview practice only. Do NOT use them as real customer evidence.

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DEBRIEF

What Did the Conversation Actually Teach You?

- Which question opened the best answer?
- Where did you accidentally pitch?
- What surprised you?
- Did the roleplay reveal a better question or assumption you need to test with a real customer?

Bottom line

A good discovery conversation creates new questions.

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PART 1 CLOSE

You Can Now Talk to the Customer

After the break:

How do you turn conversations into business-model evidence?

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PART 2

Conversations Are Not the Final Output

WHAT DID WE LEARN?

WHAT CHANGES?

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WEEK 07 RETURNS

Fact vs Interpretation

OBSERVATION	User checked the original source before trusting the opportunity.
INTERPRETATION	Trust may be a critical part of the value proposition.
BAD JUMP	Nobody trusts internship platforms.

Observation first. Interpretation second.

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PATTERNS

One Loud Customer Is Still One Customer

Customer A	Customer B	Customer C
wants notifications	wants notifications	never wants notifications

BAD REPORT	Customers want notifications.
BETTER	Two of three asked for notifications. One strongly rejected them. We need more evidence about context.

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EVIDENCE QUALITY

Discovery Evidence Ladder

STRONGER SIGNALS

- Observed behaviour
- Repeated workaround
- Money / time already spent
- Repeated problem
- Clear past event
- Decision actually made

WEAKER SIGNALS

- “Sounds cool”
- “I might use”
- “Maybe I would pay”
- General opinion
- Hypothetical answer

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BE CAREFUL

“Great Idea!” Can Teach You Nothing

A customer can genuinely like you and still:

- Never use the product
- Never pay
- Never change behaviour
- Forget the idea tomorrow

KEY LINE

COMPLIMENT ≠ COMMITMENT

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EARLY PATTERN

What Counts as a Discovery Pattern?

Useful early examples:

4 of 5 target users describe the same workaround.

3 of 4 buyers mention the same approval barrier.

Important

This is still EARLY EVIDENCE.

Do NOT say: “80% of the market...”

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B2B DISCOVERY

The Employee May Love It. The Owner May Still Say No.

USER

Does it help?

BUYER

Does it deserve adoption?

PAYER

Does it deserve budget?

BLOCKER

Security / procurement / policy / integration?

Customer discovery includes the decision system.

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CURRENT B2B CASE | APRIL 2026

Razorpay and Indian Exporters

“Businesses” Is Too Broad

What happened

Announcement dated 22 April 2026. Razorpay enabled Google Pay card payments for international transactions, positioned for Indian exporters / Indian businesses serving global customers, focused on a globally familiar checkout experience. Relevant context includes cross-border payments and international customer checkout.

Why it matters

Segment is NOT “businesses” but more specifically: Indian businesses selling to international customers. Context: cross-border checkout.

Takeaway

A vague segment like “businesses” hides the real context that shapes the whole business model.

Source: Razorpay Newsroom | 22 Apr 2026

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SEGMENT CONSEQUENCES

What Changes When the Segment Changes?

DOMESTIC INDIAN MERCHANT

UPI / local methods important
Domestic checkout context

INDIAN EXPORTER

International cards / wallets
Multi-currency context
Cross-border requirements
Globally familiar customer experience

A different segment can change value, channel, partners, resources and operations.

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DISCOVERY → CANVAS

Discovery Can Change the Canvas

ORIGINAL

CUSTOMER: Students

DISCOVERY

Students use the service, but college placement staff control official opportunity distribution.

POSSIBLE UPDATE

USER	DECISION-MAKER	CUSTOMER?
Student	**Placement cell**	**STILL UNCERTAIN**

Discovery may change one box or several boxes.

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BMC UPDATE

What Can Discovery Update?

Customer Segment	**Value Proposition**	**Channel**
Relationship	**Revenue**	**Activities**
Resources	**Partners**	**Costs**

Do not change a box just to show progress. Change it because evidence changed your belief.

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VALUE UPDATE

Update the Value Proposition Too

BEFORE	Verified internship opportunities
DISCOVERY	Students already find opportunities easily. Their bigger difficulty is knowing whether they qualify.
UPDATED VALUE	Clear eligibility-first opportunity discovery

The same problem area can produce a different value proposition after discovery.

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ACTIVITY 3

Evidence-to-Canvas Update

Duration

20 minutes

Format

Permanent teams

Use:

- Week 08 BMC
- Week 08 Value Proposition Snapshot
- REAL evidence collected in Weeks 06/07

Today's discovery roleplay may help improve your interview questions. Its simulated answers are NOT customer evidence.

Choose THREE business-model assumptions. Create a simple three-row table: ASSUMPTION | CURRENT EVIDENCE | DECISION.

ASSUMPTION	CURRENT EVIDENCE	DECISION

Decision options: KEEP AS HYPOTHESIS, CHANGE, TEST.

Change a BMC block only when REAL evidence supports it. If evidence is weak, TEST instead, or rewrite the assumption or discovery question.

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PRESENTATION 1

Discovery Improves P1 Without Adding Slides

SLIDE 1

Sharper target user

SLIDE 2

Stronger customer evidence

SLIDE 5

Clearer assumption / result / decision

DO NOT ADD: BMC slide, VPC slide, Customer persona slide

BETTER EVIDENCE. SAME FIVE-SLIDE STRUCTURE.

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CUSTOMER REALITY RADAR

Real Segments, Real Context

SWIGGY LATE NIGHT EATS

Segment: Professionals working late from offices
Context: late-night corporate ordering

RAZORPAY INTERNATIONAL PAYMENTS

Segment: Indian exporters serving global customers
Context: cross-border checkout

WHAT IS COMMON? Neither starts with “everyone.” Both define a specific context and customer job.

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WEEK 09 ASSIGNMENT

Customer Discovery Sprint

Conduct 3 REAL discovery conversations with people who match your sharpened customer segment.

Type	Time Required	Format	Submission	Deadline
Permanent team	**Approx. 60 to 75 min total including synthesis**	**Maximum 2 handwritten pages**	**One PDF per permanent team, Microsoft Teams only**	**Batch-specific deadline on Microsoft Teams**

Note: *Do NOT: pitch first, invent interviews, interview only team members, ask only "would you use this?", generate customer answers using AI, or collect unnecessary sensitive personal information.*

Note: *No audio or video recording is required. If you record anyone, take permission first. Paraphrased notes are acceptable.*

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ASSIGNMENT DETAILS

What the Two Pages Must Contain

Turn three real conversations into evidence and one justified next decision.

PAGE 1

Discovery Log

- Customer code: C1 / C2 / C3
- Why they fit the segment
- Last real incident
- Current workaround
- Biggest pain
- Time / money / effort involved
- Who makes the decision
- Important quote or observation
- One surprise

Do not include unnecessary names or phone numbers.

PAGE 2

What Changed?

1. Three repeated patterns
2. One contradiction
3. Strongest evidence
4. Weakest assumption
5. One BMC block you updated
6. Old statement → new statement
7. One Value Proposition change, if any
8. One thing still UNKNOWN
9. One assumption to test next
10. One Presentation 1 slide this strengthens

DO NOT COLLECT INTERVIEWS. COLLECT INSIGHT.

Your customer does not exist to confirm your canvas.
Your canvas exists to change when reality disagrees.

Next: Close the Business Case → Move into the Entrepreneurial Ecosystem